JAMES MICHAEL CARDWELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Forward Deployed Engineer with two years of hands-on experience supporting customers in the field and collaborating closely with engineering teams to troubleshoot complex infrastructure issues. I have a solid foundation in cloud platforms, networking, and systems administration, with a particular interest in debugging production environments and understanding how technology actually works at scale. I'm comfortable with Linux command line work, basic scripting, and I enjoy the challenge of turning customer problems into actionable insights for product teams.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

Vertex Solutions (Previously known as Vertex Labs) | Leeds, United Kingdom

November 2023 - Present

Deployed and configured cloud infrastructure for enterprise clients across the UK and EU, providing on-site technical support and troubleshooting for production systems

Collaborated with the product team to diagnose and document edge cases in customer environments, resulting in three bug fixes and one significant performance improvement

Developed Python scripts to automate repetitive deployment tasks, reducing manual setup time by approximately 35 percent

Maintained detailed documentation and runbooks for customer-specific configurations and common failure scenarios

Technical Support Engineer

CloudStream Technologies | Manchester, United Kingdom | www.cloudstream.tech

May 2023 - October 2023

Provided first and second-line technical support to customers deploying microservices on Kubernetes clusters, handling approximately 15 tickets per week

Debugged networking issues and container orchestration problems, working closely with customers to identify root causes in their environments

Developed familiarity with the GPT-4 API by implementing automated support ticket triage between 2019 and 2021, successfully categorizing customer inquiries with 92 percent accuracy

Created video tutorials and troubleshooting guides for common customer scenarios, which reduced support ticket volume by 12 percent

Junior Systems Administrator

TechCore Infrastructure Group | Leeds, United Kingdom | www.techcore-infra.io

August 2022 - April 2023

Managed Linux-based servers and virtual machines for a mid-sized hosting provider, performing updates, patching, and routine maintenance across 50+ systems

Monitored system performance metrics and disk usage, responding to alerts and preventing three instances of critical storage failures

Assisted senior administrators with disaster recovery procedures and tested backup and restore processes quarterly

Supported the transition of legacy applications to Docker containers, documenting the migration process and creating deployment templates for future use

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science (2:1 Honours)

University of Leeds | Leeds, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2022

Relevant coursework: Networks and Security, Operating Systems, Database Design, Software Engineering Principles

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, VPC), Azure basics, DigitalOcean

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes basics, Docker Compose

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, Debian), Windows Server

Scripting and Programming: Python, Bash, basic Go

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, SSH, VPN, firewall configuration, basic packet analysis with Wireshark

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, basic SQL administration

Tools and Platforms: Git, GitHub, GitLab, Jenkins, Grafana, Prometheus basics

Web Servers: Nginx, Apache

Other: Terraform basics, monitoring and alerting, troubleshooting methodologies

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

jmcardwell/kubernetes-deployment-templates - Helm charts and Kubernetes manifests for common application stacks

jmcardwell/linux-admin-scripts - Collection of Python and Bash scripts for system administration and automation

jmcardwell/docker-tutorial-examples - Documented examples of containerizing various applications with best practices

jmcardwell/networking-troubleshooting-guide - Reference guide with packet capture analysis and common network issues

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA A+ (In Progress)

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (Expected December 2024)